

jeff kao

jeffkao.ca · jeff.kao.000@gmail.com · [LinkedIn](#)

RADAR LABS

Principal Engineer | 2019–present

Designed and built HorizonDB from prototype to production: a Rust geospatial database replacing Elasticsearch and MongoDB, saving high five figures monthly and serving 1,000 QPS per core.

Built KeyVal, a Rust service indexing and serving high-cardinality datasets with sub-millisecond p99 latency.

Tech lead for the platform and maps teams; infrastructure supporting 1B+ daily API calls across 100M+ devices.

Served as Engineering Manager and Interim Head of Engineering, managing engineers and engineering managers.

NORTHSPRING TECHNOLOGIES

Co-founder | 2018

Built a profitable software business with apps featured on the Shopify App Store front page; acquired by Radar.

SOUNDCLOUD

Senior Engineer / Technical Product Manager | 2016–2018

Owned data platform product direction; introduced BigQuery and Airflow, making data lake datasets discoverable with explicit ownership and schema guarantees.

Operated online and offline data services: Kafka at 100K+ QPS, A/B testing at 10K QPS, and Spark clusters spanning hundreds of nodes.

Reduced pipeline runtime and compute costs through Spark optimization and terabyte-scale migrations from Protobuf to queryable Parquet datasets.

FOURSQUARE

Senior Engineer (Tech Lead) | 2014–2016

Led up to five engineers across web, backend, and mobile to ship opinion collection, lists, travel recommendations, search, and offline mode.

EDUCATION

University of Waterloo – BASc, Computer Engineering (Honors), 2014

Nanyang Technological University – Engineering Exchange, 2013